

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Caprese Chicken and Quinoa Bowls

with Spinach and Balsamic Vinaigrette

Caprese is Italy's iconic, summery salad of peak-season tomatoes, fresh mozzarella, and fragrant basil. Here, that trio pops up in a few extra places for a cheffy yet simple twist. Quinoa is infused with tomato paste for a little sweetness and color, then finished with more mozzarella and spinach to form the base for crispy-skinned chicken. You say Caprese; we say Capr-*easy* (... too much?).

20–30 minutes 770 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- ½ cup quinoa
- 1 container chicken stock
- ½ tablespoon tomato paste
- 2 boneless chicken breasts
- 2 ounces baby spinach
- ⅛ ounce basil, divided
- 4 ounces fresh mozzarella cheese
- ¼ pint grape tomatoes
- 1 ounce shredded mozzarella cheese
- ½ ounce grated Parmesan cheese, divided
- 1 teaspoon balsamic vinegar

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot with lid
10" medium pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

If the spinach and cheese won't quite fit in the pot with the cooked quinoa, feel free to mix everything in a large bowl instead.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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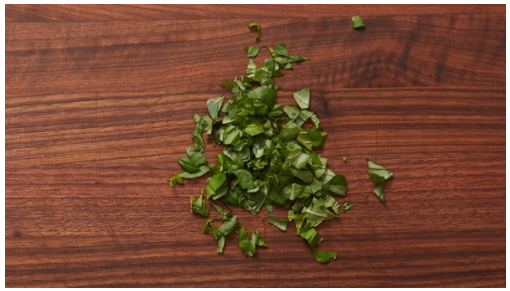
1. Cook quinoa

In a medium pot, whisk together **quinoa**, **chicken stock**, **tomato paste**, and **¼ teaspoon salt**. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is absorbed and quinoa is tender, about 15 minutes. Remove pot from heat and set aside, still covered, until Step 5.



2. Cook chicken

While quinoa cooks, pat **chicken** dry with paper towel and season all over with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper**. Heat **2 teaspoons olive oil** in a medium pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken** skin-side down and sear until skin is golden and easily lifts from pan, 6 minutes. Flip and sear opposite side until cooked through and no longer pink, about 6 minutes more. Transfer **chicken** to a plate and set aside to rest.



3. Prepare ingredients

While chicken cooks, rinse all produce. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel. Roughly chop **basil** leaves, discarding stems. Alternatively, grab a friend to roughly tear the leaves. (Pro tip: This recipe can actually be made without ever lifting a knife—feel free to skip slicing the chicken before serving, too!)



4. Make Caprese salad

Tear **fresh mozzarella** into bite-size pieces (another great task for an eager kitchen helper), and place in a medium bowl. Add **whole grape tomatoes** and **half of basil** to bowl with mozzarella and stir to combine. Set aside until ready to serve.



5. Finish quinoa and slice chicken

To pot with cooked quinoa, add **shredded mozzarella**, **spinach**, and **half of Parmesan**, and stir to combine and slightly wilt spinach (see recipe tip). If desired, cut rested **chicken** into ¼-inch slices.



6. Plate Caprese bowls

Divide **spinach quinoa** and **Caprese salad** between roomy serving bowls. In bowl from salad, whisk together **balsamic vinegar**, **1 tablespoon olive oil**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Top bowls with **chicken** and garnish with **remaining basil** and **remaining Parmesan**. Drizzle over **balsamic vinaigrette** and dig in!

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